

Fine blend: Designing this complex was as much an exercise in vision as in precision. While the exterior presents a refined, contemporary look, it's the inside story that truly leaves an impression. VIJAY SONEJI

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From **high-performance** swimming pools to column-free multi-sports arenas, the Veer Savarkar Sports Complex combines elite training, community spaces, and residential amenities under one roof.

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At the Veer Savarkar Sports Complex in Naranpura, Gujarat, a prevailing sense of spatial complexity greets you wherever you turn. It's what happens when you try to pack a great deal into too little area — something that's not immediately apparent. Yet, a closer look reveals a masterfully organised layout, thanks to a fluid design language and clever internal compartmentalisation.

Designing this complex was as much an exercise in vision as in precision. While the exterior presents a refined, contemporary look, it's the inside story that truly leaves an impression.

"The biggest challenge was to accommodate 17 sporting disciplines on just 20 acres of land," says Gujarat-based architect Sachin Gandhi, adding that his team drew from Olympic standards and Khelo India guidelines to ensure every facility met international benchmarks. Moreover, accessibility has also been ensured through the inclusion of ramps and dedicated elevators for para-athletes.

Sustainability was built into the project from day one. "We aimed for green building certification and have already received the Platinum rating," Gandhi shares. The four venues within the complex are wrapped in an additional skin that blocks direct sunlight,

allowing only indirect light to filter through — reducing both energy consumption and glare. Solar panels on the terraces generating around 300 kilowatts further strengthen the eco-friendly nature of the complex.

Economy in design runs throughout the complex. **The multi-sports arena, for instance, houses facilities for badminton, basketball, volleyball, and gymnastics under one roof.** "We have accommodated 16 badminton courts on a single floor with seating for over 5,000 spectators," says Gandhi. "We wanted a column-free span of 150 by 80 metres, making the roof both a structural feature and an aesthetic statement."

A similar blend of form and function defines the Aquatics Stadium — the venue for the 2025 Asian Aquatics Championships,